Alessandro Spina

Department of Finance
UTS Business School
University of Technology Sydney
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Education

University of Technology Sydney *2024 – present*
Assistant Professor / Lecturer in Finance

Copenhagen Business School *2018 – 2024*
Center for Financial Frictions (FRIC)
PhD in Financial Economics

University of Sydney *2022 Nov – Dec*
Visiting Scholar

Copenhagen Business School *2016 – 2018*
Masters Advanced Economics and Finance, OECON

University of Sydney *2006 – 2008*
BA Econometrics and Finance

Research Interests

Empirical macro-finance, Financial Intermediation, Monetary Policy

Research Papers

1. **Corporate Loan Spreads and Economic Activity** (2025) (with Anthony Saunders, Sascha Steffen, and Daniel Streitz). *Review of Financial Studies*. [Published version] [SSRN]

   Abstract: We investigate the predictive power of loan spreads for forecasting business cycles, specifically focusing on more constrained, intermediary-reliant firms. We introduce a novel loan-market-based credit spread constructed using secondary corporate-loan-market prices over the 1999 to 2023 period. Loan spreads significantly enhance the prediction of macroeconomic outcomes, outperforming other credit-spread indicators. The paper also explores the underlying mechanisms, differentiating between borrower fundamentals and financial frictions, with evidence suggesting that supply-side frictions are a decisive factor in loan-spread forecasting ability.

   Presentations: NZFM Conference (2022), Danmark Nationalbank, AFA (2022), Central Bank of Ireland Workshop (2021), 11th ifo Conference on Macroeconomics and Survey Data (2021), ABFER 8th Annual Conference (2021), SFS Cavalcade (2021), FIRS (2021), Frankfurt School Finance and Management: Regulating Financial Markets Conference (2019).

2. **Disagreement in Perceptions of Monetary Policy** (sole author).

   Abstract: Professional forecasts of U.S. monetary policy display persistent and large cross-sectional dispersion. What drives this disagreement? I distinguish between two sources: (i) heterogeneity in macroeconomic outlooks and (ii) heterogeneity in perceived monetary-policy rules. Using monthly Blue Chip Financial Forecasts (BCFF) panels, I estimate forecaster- and time-specific perceived policy rules. I construct a new disagreement measure that isolates

cross-sectional dispersion in perceived policy coefficients. I find disagreement is time-varying and systematic—it rises during shifts in policy frameworks. Using a counterfactual that holds macro outlooks fixed across forecasters, I show that a sizable fraction of funds-rate forecast dispersion reflects disagreement about the policy rule, not just about the economy. Finally, I document that higher policy-rule disagreement amplifies asset-price sensitivity to FOMC announcements.

3. **Option Vanna and Equity Price Pressure**, with Julian Terstegge and Paul Whelan.

   Abstract: When volatility moves, option dealers must trade the S&P 500 to stay hedged. We measure this forced trade from observed dealer positions. Dealer Vanna, the sensitivity of dealers' inventory delta to implied volatility, is persistently positive, so rising volatility forces the average book to sell $183 million per VIX point. Dealer Vanna predicts (i) the daily correlation between S&P 500 returns and VIX changes, (ii) the E-mini hedge flow that produces it, arriving within 15 minutes, and (iii) announcement-day returns around FOMC statements, which reverse the next day. Narrow event windows do not remove predictable intermediary trading demand.

   Presentations: 9th Yale Junior Finance Conference, Alpine Finance Summit 2026, SAFE Asset Pricing Workshop, 15th FIRN Annual Conference.

4. **When Credit Goes Private**, with Sascha Steffen and Daniel Streitz.

   Abstract: Private credit has moved a large part of corporate lending away from the traded loan market. We ask what becomes of the information that the traded loan price carried. Business development companies report a value for every loan they hold, and we match these values to daily dealer quotes on traded loans. In early 2024, 87.7% of these lenders' direct-loan borrowers had no quoted loan. The value reported for such a loan moves 0.36 times as much as a dealer quote when the loan market moves, does not catch up within a year, and gives little warning before the borrower gets into trouble, while the lost quote did. Yet the lenders' own spreads sort borrower risk as well without a quote as with one. The information is not destroyed; it stays with the lender. The cost falls on the investors who buy and sell fund shares at the reported values.

Service

1. Reviewer, Journal of Banking and Finance	2021
2. Reviewer, Journal of Banking and Finance	2020
3. Discussant, NZFM Conference	2022
4. Discussant, AFBC Conference	2022
5. PhD Representative on PhD School Board	2020–2023
6. PhD Representative at Finance Department Forum	2020–2023
7. PhD Brown Bag Coordinator	2021–2023
8. Advised Masters' Theses	2020

Teaching

Corporate Finance (BA) *2023–2024*
Lecturer

Corporate Finance (BA) *2020–2022*

Teaching assistant to Ulf Nielsson

Corporate Finance (BA) *2022*
Teaching assistant to Rama Seth

Macroeconomics (BA) *2018–2019*
Teaching assistant to Anna Morin

Microeconomics (BA) *2017–2019*
Teaching assistant to Martin Lau

Industry Experience

Jigsaw Strategic Research, Australia *2015*
Market Research Consultant

Macquarie Bank, Australia *2009 – 2014*
Market Research Analyst

Ernst&Young, Australia *2008*
Audit Internship

References

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Professor of Finance, Center Leader of FRIC

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